

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Office of Counter-Terrorism (UNOCT)
Senegal**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 - May 2027
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Dakar, Senegal
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Programme Management

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Valerio de Divitiis
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Head of Sport Unit, UNOCT

3. Background information

The United Nations Office of Counter-Terrorism (UNOCT) was established on 15 June 2017 through the adoption of UN General Assembly Resolution 71/291. The creation of the Office is considered as the first major institutional reform undertaken by the UN Secretary-General António Guterres following his report (A/71/858) on the Capability of the United Nations to Assist Member States in implementing the United Nations Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy.

As suggested by Secretary-General in his report (A/71/858) on the Capability of the United Nations to Assist Member States in implementing the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy, the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Coordination Compact (former CTITF) and the UN Counter-Terrorism Centre (UNCCT) were moved out of the UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs into the new Office of Counter-Terrorism.

The UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy (A/RES/60/288) and its General Assembly Review resolutions provide the substance of UNOCT's mandate.

The Office of Counter-Terrorism has five main functions:

- Provide leadership on the General Assembly counter-terrorism mandates entrusted to the Secretary-General from across the United Nations system
- Enhance coordination and coherence across the Global Counter-Terrorism Coordination Compact entities to ensure the balanced implementation of the four pillars of the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy
- Strengthen the delivery of United Nations counter-terrorism capacity-building assistance to Member States
- Improve visibility, advocacy and resource mobilization for United Nations counter-terrorism efforts
- Ensure that due priority is given to counterterrorism across the United Nations system and that the important work on preventing violent extremism is firmly rooted in the Strategy

The UN General Assembly establishes the priorities of UNOCT through the resolutions of the biennial Review of the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy. The Office works closely with UN Member States, UN entities, civil society, international and regional organizations, academia and other stakeholders strengthening existing and developing new partnerships to effectively prevent and counter terrorism.

One of the UNOCT's branches is the Special Projects and Innovation Branch (SPIB). The Branch is responsible for leading in the conceptualization, development and implementation of special technical assistance programmes that require increased coordination and partnership with other Global Compact entities and the UNCCT; developing the Office's surge capacity to better assist Member States; forging partnerships including with the private sector, academia and other public sector organizations; and developing, designing and implementing, in close collaboration with UNCCT, innovative and technological solutions applied to preventing and countering terrorism in areas such as countering terrorist travel, protection of critical infrastructure and soft targets, sports, investigative capacity and parliamentary engagement.

As part of UNOCT, the Special Projects and Innovation Branch (SPIB) actively supports the UNOCT mandate through the targeted conceptualization, as well as development and implementation of special technical assistance arrangements, which includes the work conducted under the Global Sports Programme. The Global Sports Programme was launched in 2020 as a cross-cutting initiative to: i) assist Member States in protecting vulnerable targets in the context of major sporting events, ii) leverage the power of sports and its values to strengthen social cohesion and build resilience to violent extremism, and iii) safeguard sport practice as a vehicle for empowering vulnerable categories.

UNOCT, through its Border Security Management Unit, leads the Dakar-based Integrated Border Stability Mechanism (IBSM) for West Africa with support from the International Organization for Migration (IOM), UN Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), and INTERPOL. IBSM mandate is to enhance regional security and governance, including against terrorism by directly assisting West African states to counter security threats, including the spread of violent extremism across borders.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

Support the planning and delivery of UNOCT Global Sports Programme capacity building activities in Africa, while also supporting the Secretariat of the Integrated Border Stability Mechanisms (IBSM) in West Africa established and led by UNOCT. In particular, the Fellow will :

- Research and assist with the formulation of technical assistance proposals in support of the security of major sporting events, including on border security measures, notably through and sport-based prevention of violent extremism (PVE) initiatives.

- Research information and compile up-to-date background documents on substantive matters and country or regional issues, in particular those related to strengthening border security and governance Sport.
- Draft notes, background papers, talking points, speeches, minutes of internal and external meetings and correspondence related to the security issues, in particular the security of sporting events, in particular on cross-border threats, including promoting the use of sport as a tool to prevent violent extremism as applicable.
- Prepare, maintain and update files and internal databases; designs and generates a variety of periodic and ad hoc reports, statistical tables, graphic content, work plans and budgets and other background materials/notes to facilitate review and periodic assessments.
- Assist the continued management of a georeferenced digital map of the practices comprised in the Compendium of existing policies, projects and initiatives aimed at making use of sport and its values as a tool to prevent violent extremism
- Assist the continued dissemination and delivery of UNOCT eLearning courses part of the “UNOCT Connect & Learn Platform”
- Support the overall delivery of UNOCT mandate across Africa, and in particular, perform any other duties that may be assigned by the UNOCT focal point within the IBSM Secretariat.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree (Master's degree or equivalent) in International Relations, social sciences, business administration, management, economics or a related field is required

Work experience

Experience in human rights and/or international security. Experience in an international/multilateral setting would be an asset.

Languages

English and French are the working languages of the United Nations Secretariat. For the post advertised, fluency in oral and written English and Italian is required. Knowledge of French is an asset.

Other skills

- Excellent oral and written skills; excellent drafting, formulation, reporting skills.
- Accuracy and professionalism in document production and editing.
- Excellent interpersonal skills; culturally and socially sensitive; ability to work inclusively and collaboratively with a range of partners, including grassroots community members, religious and youth organizations, and authorities at different levels; familiarity with tools and approaches of communications for development.
- Ability to work and adapt professionally and effectively in a challenging environment; ability to work effectively in a multicultural team of international and national personnel;
- Solid overall computer literacy, including proficiency in various MS Office applications (Excel, Word, etc.) and email/internet; familiarity with database management; and office technology equipment.
- Self-motivated, ability to work with minimum supervision; ability to work with tight deadlines.

Competencies

- Professionalism: demonstrates excellent knowledge of legal, policy and technical matters in relation to the security of public event. Has clear competence about technical assistance capacity-building for public and private authorities in the context of security of public spaces, against terrorist threats and responses thereto.

- Teamwork and respect for diversity: ability to operate effectively across organizational boundaries; excellent interpersonal skills; ability to establish and maintain effective partnerships and harmonious working relations in a multi-cultural, multi-ethnic, mixed-gender environment with sensitivity and respect for diversity; sensitivity and adaptability to culture, gender, religion, nationality and age; commitment to implementing the goal of gender equality by ensuring the equal participation and full involvement of women and men in all aspects of UN operations; ability to achieve common goals and provide guidance or training to colleagues;
- Planning & Organizing: Develops clear goals that are consistent with agreed strategies; identifies priority activities and assignments; adjusts priorities as required; allocates appropriate amount of time and resources for completing work; foresees risks and allows for contingencies when planning; monitors and adjusts plans and actions as necessary; uses time efficiently
- Integrity: demonstrate the values and ethical standards of the UN and UNOCT SPIB in daily activities and behaviours while acting without consideration of personal gains; resist undue political pressure in decision-making; stand by decisions that are in the organization's interest even if they are unpopular; take prompt action in cases of unprofessional or unethical behaviour; does not abuse power or authority;
- Communication: Speaks and writes clearly and effectively; listens to others, correctly interprets messages from others and responds appropriately; asks questions to clarify and exhibits interest in having two-way communication; tailors language, tone, style and format to match audience; demonstrates openness in sharing information and keeping people informed.
- Commitment to continuous learning: initiative and willingness to learn new skills and stay abreast of new developments in area of expertise; ability to adapt to changes in work environment.
- Genuine commitment towards the principles of voluntary engagement, which includes solidarity, compassion, reciprocity and self-reliance; and commitment towards UNOCT SPIB.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Write regular communications, materials, presentations and reports.
- Draft project proposals, concept notes and programmes related to the activities of the Programme.
- Assist the overall management and operations of the programmatic activities.
- Have a better understanding on the security of major sporting events and the use of sports as a tool to prevent violent extremism.
- Become familiar with the United Nations system and its procedures and processes.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

- Initial briefing with supervisor on office responsibilities.
- Draft a work plan with the fellow's main roles and responsibilities.
- Regular meetings with supervisor.
- Weekly team meetings.
- Discussion on performance appraisal.
- Regular checks in and performance monitor.